

Code of Conduct Policy Template (EU)

This Code of Conduct Policy Template is designed to help organisations craft policies to communicate the organisation's values and expectations to employees, customers and other stakeholders.

Note: This document is a draft policy and is subject to further review and expansion. It is intended for general informational purposes only and does not constitute legal or other professional advice. Please consult with qualified professional advisors as necessary to draft appropriate policies for your organization.

[Organisation Name]

Policy title: Code of Conduct Policy (E.U.)

Effective date: [Date]

Last updated: [Date]

Policy owner: [Position or department]

1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct Policy outlines the expectations for employee behavior to maintain a respectful, lawful and productive work environment. All employees, contractors and representatives of [Organisation Name] must adhere to this policy in accordance with relevant E.U. legislation.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, including full-time, part-time, temporary and contract workers, as well as volunteers and representatives acting on behalf of [Organisation Name].

3. Workplace conduct

Employees must conduct themselves in a professional, ethical and lawful manner at all times. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Treating colleagues, clients and stakeholders with respect and dignity.
- Refraining from discrimination, harassment and retaliation as prohibited under the E.U. Charter of Fundamental Rights.
- Avoiding conflicts of interest that may compromise the organisation's integrity.
- Adhering to workplace safety and health regulations as per the relevant E.U. directives.

4. Anti-discrimination and harassment

[Organisation Name] strictly prohibits discrimination and harassment based on sex, race, color, ethnic or social origin, genetic features, language, religion or belief, political or any other opinion, membership of a national minority, property, birth, disability, age or sexual orientation, as outlined in the E.U. Charter of Fundamental Rights. Any violations must be reported to HR or management immediately.

5. Confidentiality and data protection

Employees must safeguard sensitive and proprietary information, including, but not limited to, customer data, trade secrets and personal employee information, in compliance with relevant privacy laws such as the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

6. Workplace safety and substance use

To ensure a safe working environment, employees must:

- Comply with E.U. health and safety standards.
- Report workplace hazards or unsafe conditions immediately.
- Abstain from substance abuse while on duty. The use of illegal drugs and unauthorised alcohol consumption on organisation premises is strictly prohibited.

7. Use of organisation property

Employees must use organisation resources responsibly. Misuse, theft or unauthorized access to company property, including electronic systems and intellectual property, is subject to disciplinary action.

8. Compliance with laws and regulations

[Organisation Name] must adhere to all applicable E.U. laws, including:

- The E.U. Charter of Fundamental Rights for fundamental rights protections.
- The Working Time Directive regarding work hours and rest periods.
- The GDPR for data protection and privacy.
- The Health and Safety Framework Directive for workplace safety.

It is expected that employees will also adhere to the above compliance obligations, where applicable.

9. Reporting violations



Employees must report any suspected violations of this policy to their supervisor, HR or a designated compliance officer. Retaliation against individuals who report violations in good faith is strictly prohibited.

10. Disciplinary actions

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. The organization reserves the right to investigate and address misconduct accordingly.

11. Acknowledgment and agreement

Employees must read, understand and comply with this policy. A signed acknowledgment form confirming agreement to abide by this Code of Conduct may be required as a condition of employment.

This policy is subject to review and modification as needed to ensure compliance with evolving laws and organisational standards.

Approval:

Policy Owner: [Position/Name]

Date approved: [Date]